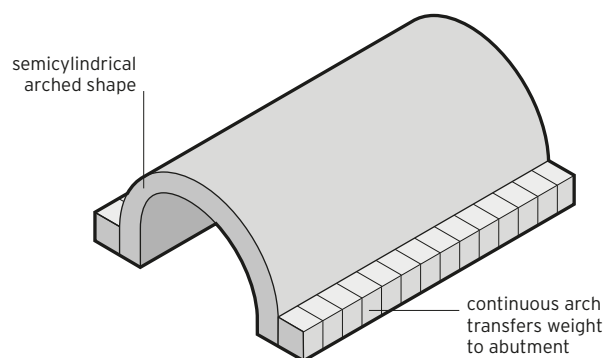
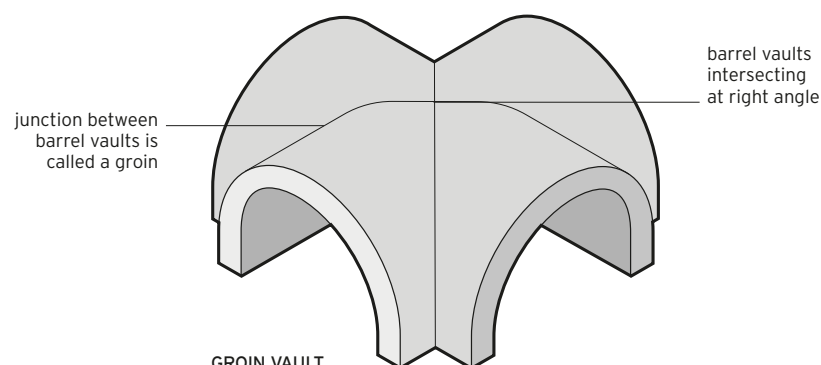


VAULT

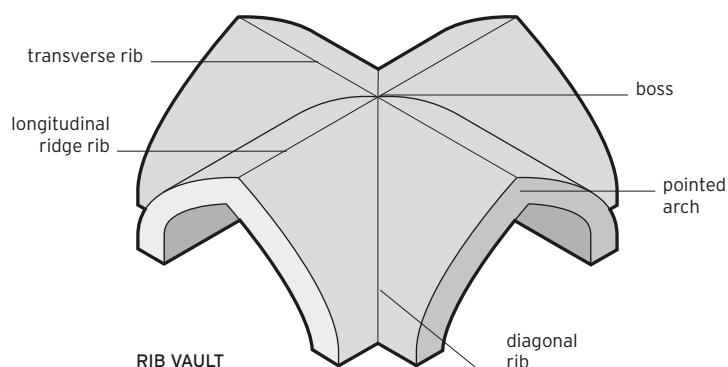
A vault is an arch extended lengthwise to cover a space. The most basic form is called a barrel vault, and its use dates from as far back as the time of the ancient Egyptians. When two vaults intersect at right angles, the result is a groin vault. Skilled medieval stonemasons evolved this into the rib vault, which is a groin vault with pointed arches, and the fan vault, with multiple ribs radiating from the central groin. The barrel vault came back into common use during the Industrial Revolution with the invention of iron framing and was popular for large spaces such as railway sheds and exhibition halls.



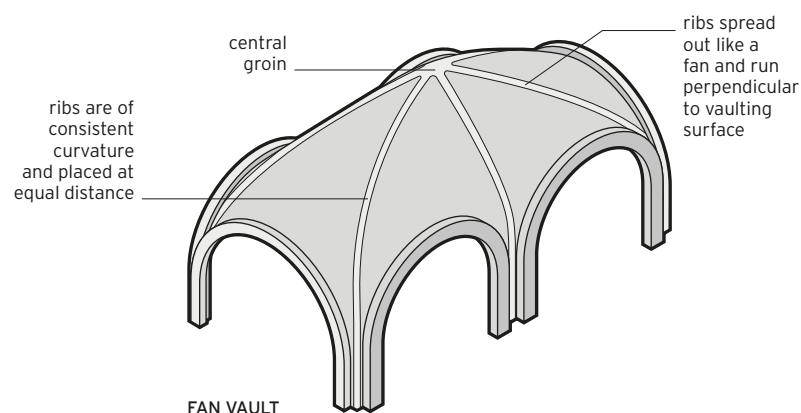
BARREL VAULT



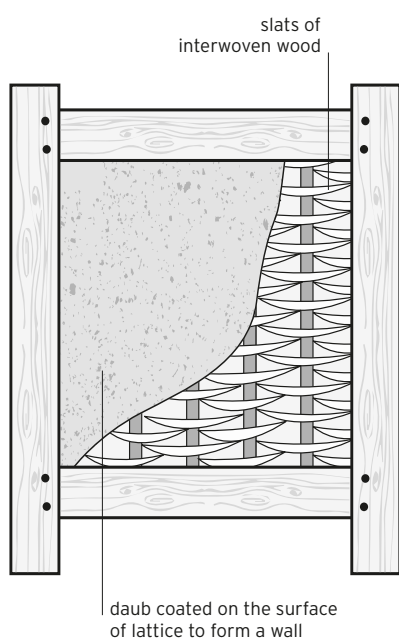
GROIN VAULT



RIB VAULT



FAN VAULT



WATTLE ▲ A construction using thin branches or light, thin slats of wood woven into a lattice. It was traditionally

used for fences. Combined with daub—a sticky, wet clay—it is also used for the walls of buildings. *See also* daub.

WHEEL WINDOW A round window with a central boss from which spokelike mullions radiate. *See also* mullions.

X

XYSTUS The ancient Greek term for the covered portico of a gymnasium used by athletes to exercise. In ancient Rome, it meant a garden walkway or terrace. *See also* portico.

Z

ZIGGURAT A characteristic monumental structure of ancient Mesopotamia that takes the form of a series of ascending terraces that decrease in size as one climbs them, like a stepped pyramid.